

Potentially Vulnerable Areas Dataset Version 3.0



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1. Release Details

Release Date: 18 December 2024

Version 3.0 of the SEPA Potentially Vulnerable Areas (PVA) dataset was published on 18 December 2024.

2. Dataset Description

These are areas where highest flood risk exists now or is likely to occur in the future. They help Scotland to understand and prioritise where work could be of most benefit. They are a vital part of protecting people, properties, businesses, communities, infrastructure, and our environment. The PVAs are determined from the National Flood Risk Assessment and are the building blocks of the flood risk management plans.

SEPA is responsible under the Flood Risk Management (Scotland) Act 2009 for reviewing and where necessary updating the NFRA and PVAs every six years. The first PVAs were published in 2011, and then updated in 2018. Thereafter they must be reviewed and updated every 6 years.

In 2011 and 2018 the PVAs were large geographic areas based on river catchments or coastal areas. They were designated based on the potential current or future risk from all sources of flooding. This designation was informed by the [National Flood Risk Assessment](#).

Based on feedback from our partners and the public, the main change for the 2024 PVA review is a move to community based PVAs. The PVAs were then reviewed using the NFRA.

For more information you can visit SEPA's flood risk management planning section on the [flooding page](#).

PVAs are located within Flood Risk Management Local Plan Districts (LPDs) which are a broader unit of management.

Not all properties within a PVA will be affected by flooding. Similarly, there will be homes and businesses outside PVAs which are at risk of flooding.

452 PVAs were identified following a detailed review and a public consultation. The identification of PVAs is reviewed every 6 years.

The PVAs within this dataset will be used for flood risk management planning purposes for planning cycle 3. This covers the period 2028-34.

3. Related Datasets

Other datasets available that can also be used to understand the identification and co-ordination of flood risk management in Scotland include:

- Flood Risk Management Local Plan Districts

4. Data Attribution

Any use of this product must fully acknowledge the sources of the data. The following data attribution statements must be used:

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An attribution statement should be clearly visible where data from SEPA has been included in your work/product.

5. Data Usage Precautionary Note

The data provided within the Potentially Vulnerable Areas dataset reflects the information that we hold within our databases. Whilst we aim to avoid quality problems and provide datasets without errors, they may still exist. If issues are experienced whilst using the dataset, users are requested to [report](#) these to us so that they can be logged for consideration within a future version of the dataset.

6. Dataset Content

The metadata fields which can be found within the PVA dataset are described below in the detailed dataset schema.

Table 1: Description of PVA metadata fields

Field Name	Description	Data Type	Field Length	Guidance
OBJECTID/FID	Internal Feature Number	Integer	-	Automatically generated number
PVA C3 ID	PVA Reference	Integer	-	Unique identifier for the PVA in FRM planning cycle 3 (2028-34)
PVA C3 Name	PVA Name	String	200	Name of the PVA in FRM planning cycle 3 (2028-34)
Designation Date	Designation date	Date	-	Date PVA was initially designated
Change since C2	Change from cycle 2	String	255	Has the PVA changed since FRM planning cycle 2 (2022-28)?

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